

THARAKA MALWATHTHA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT professional with hands-on network infrastructure experience including LAN/WAN connectivity, VLAN segmentation, routing, DNS/DHCP administration, and Active Directory built through production support work and reinforced through structured lab simulations in Cisco Packet Tracer and VMware. Delivered measurable infrastructure reliability results, including 99% uptime across server and network infrastructure, an 85% first-contact resolution rate, and a 15% reduction in critical incident resolution time. Holds CCNA and CompTIA A+ certifications and brings a disciplined, ticketing-driven troubleshooting approach, along with adaptability developed in fast-paced, high-pressure operational roles.

RELEVANT SKILLS

- Support & ITSM: ServiceNow ticketing, ticket triage/escalation, systematic troubleshooting and documentation, asset tracking, incident response
- Scripting & Automation: PowerShell, Bash scripting for task automation and troubleshooting
- Coordination & Documentation: Project/PoC coordination, vendor quote and incident coordination, meeting/status documentation, IT process documentation, end-user training
- Networking: TCP/IP, LAN/WAN, Wi-Fi infrastructure, DNS, DHCP, VLAN configuration, inter-VLAN routing, OSPF, STP, LACP
- Monitoring & Maintenance: Proactive system/network monitoring, automated alerting, scheduled maintenance and patching, backup configuration

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Hybrid Identity & Endpoint Management Lab ([Blog Post](#))

Azure / Entra ID / Intune / Group Policy / Windows Server 2022 / Windows 11

- Configured identity, access controls, Conditional Access, MFA, device management, and domain services.
- Automated infrastructure and administration tasks using PowerShell, Microsoft Graph, and Bicep.
- Troubleshoot and resolved issues involving licensing, Azure VM quotas, LDAP/UDP connectivity, Kerberos time synchronization, RDP access, and Active Directory trust relationships.

Active Directory Lab ([Blog Post](#))

Windows Server 2019 / Active Directory / DNS / VMware

- Deployed and configured Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS) with integrated DNS
- Built a virtualized lab environment using VMware Workstation for domain simulation
- Diagnosed DHCP and DNS misconfigurations affecting client connectivity
- Established a stable domain environment supporting centralized authentication and name resolution

Enterprise Network Simulation ([Blog Post](#))

Cisco Packet Tracer / VLANs / Inter-VLAN Routing / OSPF / STP / LACP

- Designed and implemented a multi-switch network with VLAN segmentation and inter-VLAN routing
- Configured DHCP services for dynamic IP allocation across multiple subnets
- Implemented link aggregation (LACP) and Rapid PVST for redundancy and loop prevention
- Diagnosed and resolved routing and DHCP issues through CLI-based troubleshooting

CERTIFICATIONS

- [Cisco Certified Network Associate \(CCNA\)](#)
- [CompTIA A+ \(220-1201 / 220-1202\)](#)
- [CompTIA Server+](#)
- [Microsoft AZ-900](#)
- [Microsoft SC-900](#)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Systems & Security Engineer, Connex Information Technologies, Remote, Nov 2021 - Dec 2022

- Managed end-to-end help desk operations as first point of contact for 50+ internal users via a centralized ticketing system, achieving an 85% first-contact resolution rate and reducing average response time by 15% through structured triage and escalation.
- Administered Active Directory and Group Policy, including user provisioning, password management, and permission/access control, maintaining secure and auditable access across the organization.
- Provided cross-platform desktop support across Windows and Ubuntu Linux environments, maintaining 99% uptime across production and test servers through scheduled maintenance, backups, and proactive monitoring.
- Coordinated the resolution of 10+ critical incidents annually with external vendors and multi-vendor hardware/NAS providers, applying a structured incident response process that reduced resolution time by 15%.
- Led a Desktop Virtualization Proof of Concept from initial scoping through stakeholder buy-in and purchase approval, and documented recurring fixes as self-service procedures, improving team efficiency by 20% and reducing onboarding time by 20%.

EDUCATION

Lambton College - Postgraduate Certificate in DevOps for Cloud Computing, Aug 2024

Rajarata University of Sri Lanka - BSc. Information Technology, Jun 2022

Plymouth University - BSc (Hons) Computer Networks, Jul 2019